Unknown Hinson

A Companion Guide

The King of Country Western Troubadours
Stuart Daniel Baker, b. November 7, 1954, Albemarle, North Carolina

Music persona, public-access television, and voice acting
Prepared August 9, 2026

Spoiler tier: not applicable. This covers a real performer and a documented public career, told in full.

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Quick Take

Unknown Hinson is a bit that got out of hand in the best possible way. Stuart Daniel Baker, a music teacher and union session guitarist from Albemarle, North Carolina, invented a 400-year-old hillbilly vampire in 1993 for a Charlotte public-access sketch show, and then stayed in that character, publicly, for nearly thirty years. The joke is a rhinestone-suited lecher with blacked-out teeth singing about other men's wives. The thing underneath the joke is a genuinely excellent guitar player, a disciplined songwriter, and a piece of sustained character work that critics kept comparing to Andy Kaufman's Tony Clifton. Country Standard Time, reviewing his 1999 debut, wrote that he "proves to be a supremely gifted craftsman" and also correctly predicted he would never break through, because country music has no appetite for deliberately offensive comedy. He found his mass audience sideways instead, voicing Early Cuyler on Adult Swim's Squidbillies for twelve seasons. Then in August 2020 the whole apparatus collapsed in eight days over a Facebook post about Dolly Parton. Worth your time if you like outlaw country, virtuoso guitar, or watching someone commit absolutely to a terrible idea. Approach the lyrics knowing what they are.

Where He Came From

The character was born on Charlotte public-access television around 1993, and it was not a solo act. Baker created Unknown Hinson for a sketch and music show called Reb and Unknown's Wild Wild South, made with his creative partner Don Swan, who played a character named Rebel Helms. The format ran roughly one guest, one black-and-white scene, and one Unknown Hinson music video per episode, plus songs and skits engineered to be as politically incorrect as the medium would allow.

Swan died in 1995. Baker spun the character off into The Unknown Hinson Show, which won Creative Loafing Charlotte's reader poll for Best Public-Access Television Show four years running. The recurring bit most fans of the later touring act never saw: a ventriloquist dummy carved in his own likeness, called Little Bit Hinson, which he used to sing a duet with himself. A ventriloquist doll of yourself is the purest possible expression of the character's vanity, and it costs nothing, which is the entire public-access aesthetic in one prop.

The cult spread further than a local cable channel should allow, and the mechanism was not primarily VHS tape trading, as fan accounts usually have it. The Wild Wild South was picked up by the satellite oddities outlet Weird TV, which carried it out of the Southeast. When the access show ended in the late 1990s, Baker converted that audience into a touring career and sold records off the merch table on his own Uniphone label. Mainstream country radio ignored him completely. Shock-jock radio did not.

The Man Behind the Fangs

This is the fact that reframes everything else. Baker is a member of American Federation of Musicians Local 342 in Charlotte, a music teacher and studio musician from a musical North Carolina family. He is naturally left-handed and plays right-handed because his father taught him that way. He moved to New York City in 1979 for session work, called the studio scene "dog eat dog," put in about two years of guitar and bass sessions and band subbing, then came back south to do day sessions while moonlighting in a honky-tonk bar band in Darlington, South Carolina.

He has described those bar-band years as the field research that became Unknown Hinson. The character is not a redneck caricature invented from outside and imposed on the South. It is assembled from a working musician's firsthand time inside Carolina honky-tonks, by a man from Albemarle. Whether that makes the caricature better or just better informed is the argument fans have been having for twenty years.

The playing is not part of the joke. Billy Bob Thornton hired him into The Boxmasters in late 2008, playing bass and lead guitar under the name Danny Baker, in a vintage suit and pencil tie with no makeup, no widow's peak, and no accent. Thornton called him "one of my favorite songwriters and a genius picker." Matt Groening called him a "guitar maniac, and funny as hell to boot." Hank Williams III has Baker's face tattooed on his bicep. Tom Petty reportedly asked him how he got his sound and got back: "Well all I do is just plug in and go." The owner of the Pour House in Charleston put it more efficiently: "He rips."

> *A lot of people pin me as just a hee-haw act, but I try to have quality music.*
>
> *Unknown Hinson, to Mountain Xpress*

How the Kayfabe Worked

The in-character biography is fully worked out and deliberately impossible. His mother, Miss Hinson, sang traditional western folk and disappeared when he was ten. The name comes off the paperwork: "says right there on my birth certificate, Mama: Miss Hinson. Daddy: Unknown." He ran away at fourteen to a carnival sideshow, where he learned guitar and could lift fifty-pound weights with his tongue. In 1963 he was framed for the murder of his carnival boss and sentenced to thirty years in the Illinois State Penitentiary on charges that also included nineteen paternity suits, vampirism, and random grave robbing. He learned music from prison radio. He was released in 1993.

Note the arithmetic. He is twenty-one in 1963 and also four hundred years old, and his prison release is pinned to the exact year the television show premiered. The mythology is not meant to hold together. It is a satire of outlaw-country authenticity claims, where every performer needs a jail story and a hard-luck mother.

What makes it more than a costume is that Baker enforced it at the business layer. He gave interviews as Hinson for years. He categorically denied that Danny Baker, a Charlotte musician, had anything to do with him, calling Baker an obsessed fan. As late as 2019 his booking agent was still refusing to arrange out-of-character interviews: "He's pretty elusive. I'm sorry but I can't. As an agent I just don't have the authority to do that." That is Tony Clifton discipline, and the comparison shows up in almost everything written about him.

On the vampire question he was careful in a way that is easy to miss. He never actually claimed to be one.

> *That was something that was started by, pardon the expression, the evil, wicked press.*
>
> *Unknown Hinson, Country Standard Time, 2004*

> *If people believes in Santy Claus or the Easter Bunny, or calls me a vampire, I'm gonna let 'em. Don't bother me none.*
>
> *Unknown Hinson*

He let the fans build the legend and simply declined to correct it. That is a materially smarter posture than asserting it, and it is why the act held up for three decades.

Early Cuyler and Squidbillies

The common assumption is that Adult Swim built Early Cuyler around him. They did not. The character existed first, originally named Arvee, and Hinson won the part off an audition tape. Co-creator Dave Willis has described the process bluntly: they went through tape after tape of "really terrible southern accents from the Tom Hanks School of Forrest Gump acting," and a newly hired background artist named Chris said check this guy out. Jim Fortier, per Willis, "was adamant right off the bat. He was like this guy. We have to get this guy."

What happened after the casting is that the character bent toward the performer across twelve seasons. Hinson said the creators gave him "a lot of room to improvise and ad lib," that Early "has evolved from season to season," and that "I do incorporate a lot of myself into the character." Willis credited the voice with carrying the show: "even if our lines aren't always as funny it's his voice, and it's just that extra thing that separates" a good cartoon from a great one. One genuinely surprising note from Willis: Baker "winced a little bit at some of the profanity." The man behind the reprobate had lines he did not want to cross.

A production detail that ruins a nice mental image: the Squidbillies cast recorded separately, not together. Hinson cut most of Early's dialogue in a studio near his home in North Carolina. Dana Snyder recorded Granny from Los Angeles. Williams Street in Atlanta was the production house and the animation was done by Radical Axis through season six, roughly seven hundred working hours per episode, then Awesome Inc. The famous booth chemistry never existed. It is one man alone in a room in North Carolina, assembled into an ensemble afterward.

He voiced Early from the 2005 premiere through season twelve, about 123 episodes, plus a 2004 Anime Talk Show special and a 2010 Carl appearance. Much of the 2020 coverage said fifteen years and fifteen seasons. Twelve seasons across fifteen years is the accurate framing.

One more piece of trivia worth having: the Squidbillies theme is an excerpt of Billy Joe Shaver's "Warrior Man," and later seasons ran a rotating cast of cover versions reportedly including Willie Nelson, George Jones, Lynyrd Skynyrd, Weird Al Yankovic, Alabama Shakes, Bob Mould, Ty Segall, and Hinson himself. A show whose lead voice actor covers his own show's theme song is a pleasantly recursive artifact.

The Records

The discography is a self-release story with one brief major-label interruption. He wrote and produced everything himself, and played every instrument on the 1999 debut.

Discography

- 21 Chart-Toppers. Recorded early 1990s, Uniphone, released 1994. Reissued on CD in 2005 and made available digitally April 16, 2024. The title is a joke about never having charted.
- The Future Is Unknown. 1999, Uniphone Records, 18 tracks. Reissued March 28, 2004 on Capitol Records Nashville as a 15-track version.
- Rock 'n' Roll Is Straight from Hell. 2002, Capitol Records. An EP or mini-album.
- Target Practice. 2006, Coffin Case Records. Reportedly issued download-only and never stocked in US music stores at release.
- Live and Undead. 2008 per Wikipedia, Uniphone / sdb Music. Some sources date it 2006 or credit Coffin Case in 2007. Recorded at a sold-out Halloween show in North Carolina.
- Reloaded. 2012, Uniphone / sdb Music.
- Live and Undead II. 2020, Uniphone Records.
- Unknown World. 2021, 12 tracks. A post-firing studio album almost nobody has heard.

He also appears on The Squidbillies Present: Music for Americans Only Made by Americans in China for Americans Only God Bless America, U.S.A., a 35-track Williams Street compilation from January 2012 that puts him alongside Lucinda Williams, Gillian Welch, Todd Snider, Bonnie Prince Billy, Hayes Carll, Jimmie Dale Gilmore, and David Rawlings.

One correction worth recording: "Songs I Taught the Hank Williams" circulates as a Hinson album title and could not be verified in any database. Treat it as a misattribution unless a primary source turns up.

What the Critics Said

Country Standard Time is the sympathetic pole. Reviewing The Future Is Unknown:

> *I have seen country music's future, and the future is Unknown. He is the funniest artist to come along since the Austin Lounge Lizards or the Five Chinese Brothers, but where those guys were politically and socially aware, Unknown has only one thing on*

> *his mind, the art of love. He is not a handsome man, he has only two teeth and his face is a composite of all the worst features of Elvis Presley, Richard Nixon and Vlad Dracula, but he is a born romantic.*
>
> *Country Standard Time*

The same outlet later diagnosed precisely why he would stay a cult act: in conception and execution he "proves to be a supremely gifted craftsman," but country music "doesn't have much of a taste for politically incorrect humor." AllMusic represents the other pole, giving the debut three stars out of five and filing songs like "Hippie Girl" as novelty-radio material. That split, craftsman versus novelty bin, is the entire critical tension around the act, and it never resolved.

The institutional recognition he did get came from outside Nashville. "Torture Town" won Best Alternative Country Song at the 2009 Independent Music Awards, including the popular vote, and he won Best Male Outlaw Artist at the 2014 Ameripolitan Music Awards. He played the Ameripolitan shows from 2015 to 2017, appeared on Jimmy Kimmel Live on April 20, 2009 billed as a full-time guitar player and part-time voice actor, and opened for Willie Nelson in 2008.

What You Might Not Know

The fangs are not prosthetics

The look is jet-black hair in an exaggerated widow's peak, drawn-on eyebrows, glued-on muttonchops, a rhinestoned Western gambler's coat from a rodeo tailor, a black string tie, and blacked-out front teeth that leave the canines reading as fangs. The vampire effect is subtractive. He paints teeth out rather than gluing anything on. That is exactly the trick a performer with no budget invents, and it reads the same under bad cable-access lighting and a club spotlight.

The guitar is a Reverend, not a Gretsch

Reverend Musical Instruments built him a signature model on the Club King and 290 platform: semi-hollow korina body with a solid spruce top slimmed to an inch and a half, body shape shrunk about ten percent, full-length center block, 24.75-inch scale, maple neck and maple fingerboard, bat position inlays, engraved pickguard, and dual P-90-style pickups with Reverend's Bass Contour control. On the pickups: "they can clean up and twang or get fat for more rock tones." He toured with two identical units distinguished only by headstock veneers, a Fender Super-Sonic 100 head into a matching 2x12, and one Vox ToneLab LE handling volume, chorus, overdrive, and tremolo. That is a working-club rig: two guitars, one head, one floor unit, nothing to break. A second model exists under his real name, the Reverend Stu D. Baker Signature, which is a small artifact of the persona's commercial arc all by itself.

The band was stable for a quarter century

Drummer Bill "Buddy Boy" Scott had been with him since 1993, with Roger "Tiny" Kohrs on bass. He credited that lineup with the "musical chemistry" that let them improvise on stage. Twenty-five years with the same drummer is not how novelty acts operate.

The songwriting rule was a memory test

> *If I write something, walk away from it until the next day, then can't remember it, it ain't worth recording.*
>
> *Unknown Hinson, Creative Loafing*

He also insisted "every song is about an experience that I lived through, or at least witnessed." His advice to players, delivered in character: "Practice your guitar, piana or whatever, at least a half hour a day. Don't give up because you never know."

The vocabulary

The invented dialect is the most portable part of the act and the reason he has a meme afterlife: womerns, rakkerds, party likker, rawk, and "yeh-yeh" as all-purpose punctuation. Anything of his own quality is "chart-toppin'." Everyone is "Hoss." Self-applied titles include The King of Country Western Troubadours, Chart-Toppin' Rockabilly Vampire, and God's Gift to the Womerns. The same register went straight into Early Cuyler, which is how the dialect outlived the music's actual reach by an order of magnitude.

The song titles run one consistent gag, the adulterer's point of view: "I Ain't Afraid of Your Husband," "Before Your Husband Gets Home," "Unlock This Bathroom Door," "Polly Urethane" (a love song to an inflatable doll), "Barbie-Q," "Alkyhol Withdrawl," "Fish Camp Woman," "Don't Bite the Lips That Kiss You," "Black and Blue Christmas."

His fans were disproportionately famous

Verified stage-sharing: Hank Williams III, the Reverend Horton Heat, Marty Stuart (Hinson played Stuart's Late Night Jam at the Ryman during Fan Fair 2002), and Ed King of Lynyrd Skynyrd. Verified admirers: Billy Bob Thornton, Matt Groening, Tim Robbins, Tom Petty, and Hank III's bicep. Frequently claimed but not substantiated by any source found: Jello Biafra, David Allan Coe, and Rob Zombie. The pattern is telling. Cartoonists, actors, and guitar players loved him. Nashville never showed up.

Satire or Grotesque: The Argument That Never Ended

Where he sits musically is not hard to place. The lineage runs from Hasil Adkins, the West Virginia one-man band whose "She Said" the Cramps covered in 1983, through the Cramps' art-school horror camp, into the Reverend Horton Heat's Smoke 'Em If You Got 'Em in 1990. Southern Culture on the Skids was working a parallel affectionate-kitsch version out of Chapel

Hill in the same state and the same decade. Press filed Hinson as country-side psychobilly and the awards came from the outlaw wing.

What separates him inside that lineage is the character. Adkins was authentically unhinged. The Cramps were a band doing horror. Southern Culture on the Skids is affectionate kitsch. Hinson is the only one running a sustained, kayfabe-protected persona with an invented criminal biography, which is why the Kaufman comparison keeps coming back.

The harder question is whether the hillbilly grotesque punches down. There is actual scholarship on this, though it is aimed at Squidbillies rather than the music. Nick Bowman and Jeremy Groskopf published "Appalachia: Where the Squids Hate the Chalkies" in KB Journal in fall 2010, reading the show through Kenneth Burke's theory of identification. Their argument is that the hillbilly caricature is a transitional scapegoat, a piece of misdirection, and the real target is the Chalkies, suburbanites who deny their rural heritage and hide consumption, infidelity, and hypocrisy behind respectability. Because the squids and the Chalkies are rendered morally equivalent, the show collapses the superiority the stereotype usually props up. The New York Times read it similarly, describing the show as taking backwoods stereotypes and turning them into a cudgel for hitting the Lost Cause, fundamentalism, segregation, and Southern poverty.

The strongest defense is authorship. Dave Willis and Jim Fortier were both raised in Conyers, Georgia, and describe the material as their own: "We plowed all of our stories of growing up in Conyers, Georgia into the show." Hinson made the same argument for his own act: "I don't think it pokes too much at the South. I'm a Southerner and it don't offend me."

The complication is obvious and unavoidable. The lens was operated by a performer whose entire career was a costume of Southern grotesquerie, and who was eventually removed for saying, out of character and without irony, the kind of thing the character said for laughs. A persona built to make that distinction unfindable does not get to invoke it later.

August 2020

If you remember this as a 2021 story, that is the recasting. The firing happened over eight days in August 2020.

The timeline

- June 3, 2020. He announces on Facebook that he will play no more shows. Osteoarthritis: "my hands are absolutely shot." This is ten weeks before anything else happens, and it matters.
- August 13, 2020. Responding to coverage of Dolly Parton voicing support for Black Lives Matter, he posts: "So, now this freak titted, old Southern bimbo is a BLM lover? Remember, slut, Rednecks made you a Millionaire!" He also calls her a self-racist and tells critics to unfriend him.
- August 14, 2020. Reverend Guitars: "We are no longer associated with Unknown Hinson. We have stopped production on his guitars and we have removed him from our website."

- August 16, 2020. Jim Fortier and Dave Willis issue a statement: the views "do not reflect our own personal values or the values of the show," and "production of Squidbillies will continue without Mr. Baker, effective immediately."
- About August 18, 2020. He posts, then deletes: "I just hope you a**holes are happy you took a good Man and talent down. You succeeded. Be proud that you ruined a person's life. I gave my best to you assholes for over 30 years. I'll remember you bastards!"
- August 20, 2020. Atomic Music Group drops him. Agent Matthew Mentele: the comments "do not reflect the ideals or values of myself or any of the agents at Atomic Music Group."
- August 21, 2020. An apology, later deleted: "I have sincerely apologized for my post regarding Dolly Parton, BLM, race and everything," adding "if you're not satisfied with my apology, just tell me what else you want."
- November 1, 2021. Adult Swim announces Tracy Morgan as the new voice of Early Cuyler. The thirteenth and final season premieres November 7, 2021.

Two pieces of context, offered as context and not as exculpation. The Billboard coverage he reacted to had trimmed Parton's quote, which in full was "of course Black lives matter. Everybody matters." And the posts went out on a personal page under his real name with no ironic framing, which is why the persona defense was never available.

Reaction split about how you would expect. A Dolly Parton fan account's "you come for the queen, you better not miss" went wide. Country artist Elizabeth Cook said she was sad and hoped "cancel culture and hate culture give way to one compassion culture." Casting Tracy Morgan, a Black comedian, as a white-coded Georgia hillbilly squid was read by several outlets as a deliberate and pointed choice rather than a neutral replacement.

The apology was widely read as a non-apology, since it is mostly an apology about having already apologized, wrapped in a conditional. That framing is why the story kept running for another week.

Where He Is Now

The career ended on his hands more than on the scandal. Carpal tunnel forced an earlier retirement announcement in November 2012 after eighteen years on the road, which he reversed within eight months after the death of his wife and manager, Margo Baker, saying he had been "hit yet again with the traveling Jones." Osteoarthritis ended touring in June 2020, two months before the firing. In July 2023 he disclosed that he was recovering from two strokes and in physical therapy, and by mid-2024 was posting about a year and a half of rehab. For a player whose reputation rests entirely on picking, that is the real ending.

As of August 2026 he is not touring, has no label and no booking agent, and sells direct to fans through an eBay storefront. His website is effectively a static archive. The active social presence runs under the banner "Unknown Hinson, Veg McArtful, Stuart Baker," which is notable twice over: he now signs his real name, and Veg McArtful is a third character, one that actually dates back to the surviving Wild Wild South footage and which he has been teasing as a revival. 21

Chart-Toppers went up digitally in April 2024. He still offers to autograph and personalize anything bought from the store at no extra charge, which as far as I can tell is the last remaining direct fan-to-artist channel he has.

Where to Start

The practical problem first

His studio catalog is essentially not on streaming in 2026. The Spotify artist page shows about 2,000 monthly listeners and surfaces basically one track, "Baby Let's Play Rough," a 98-second cut from a 2005 various-artists compilation called Bubbahey Mud Truck. Apple Music and Deezer show the same truncated picture. None of The Future Is Unknown, Target Practice, Rock 'n' Roll Is Straight from Hell, or Reloaded appears as a catalog album. Anyone told to go listen on Spotify will conclude he recorded one song.

The real access paths are YouTube (the official channel plus the auto-generated Topic channel), iTunes and Apple downloads, Unknown World which does exist as a standalone 2021 Apple Music release, physical CDs through the official eBay store, and the Discogs marketplace for vinyl.

Albums, in order

- Target Practice (2006). Start here. It is his most-played album by a comfortable margin, it holds "Torture Town," and it lands at the point where the character, the songwriting, and the guitar had all matured.
- The Future Is Unknown (1999). The origin document, and the one he played every instrument on. Historically the important record even if it is not the one people replay.
- Live and Undead (2008). The case for the guitar. Recorded at a sold-out Halloween show, and at least one reviewer reached for Live at Leeds and Kick Out the Jams as comparisons. If you suspect the whole thing is a novelty bit, this is the record that argues otherwise.
- Unknown World (2021). The deep cut. A post-cancellation studio album with near-zero plays anywhere. If you finish the catalog, this is what is left.

Songs

- "Torture Town" — the one outside-validated song in the catalog, and the right pick for a skeptic.
- "Baby Let's Play Rough" — by far his most-heard recording, more by streaming accident than by fan ranking, but a fine 98-second introduction.
- "Unlock This Bathroom Door" — the signature live piece. Two independent sources single it out, and it plays better on stage than on record, which is why it does not chart high on play counts.
- "I Ain't Afraid of Your Husband" — the thesis statement of the entire lyrical project.

- "Polly Urethane" — a genuinely tender love song to an inflatable doll, and the clearest demonstration of the craftsman-versus-novelty tension.
- "Hippie Girl," "Foggy Windows," "Venus Bound," "Alkyhol Withdrawl," "Rock 'n' Roll Is Straight from Hell" — the rest of the essentials by play count.

If you are coming from Squidbillies

Season 8 is the best-rated Hinson-voiced season and the safest entry block. Season 12 rates highest overall on fan voting but is his last, since he was fired mid-2020 and season 13 recast Early with Tracy Morgan. A Hinson-focused viewer should treat seasons 1 through 12 as the run and season 13 as a separate curiosity. For a single episode, fan rankings point at S8E5 "A Jailhouse Divided" or S3E15 "Flight of the Deep Fried Pine Booby." The show streams free with ads on Adult Swim's own site, and by subscription on HBO Max.

If You Liked This

Musicians

- Hank Williams III, anything. The single most natural crossover, and the man has Hinson's face on his arm. His road band is the connective tissue of this entire scene.
- Th' Legendary Shack Shakers, Cockadoodledon't (2003). Called an atomic psychobilly album by the Houston Press, and the start of the Tentshow Trilogy. Same Southern gothic energy, played straight.
- Reverend Horton Heat, Smoke 'Em If You Got 'Em (1990). The direct predecessor and a frequent tourmate. If you want the playing without the character, this is it.
- Hasil Adkins. The authentically unhinged West Virginia one-man band who sits upstream of all of it. The Cramps covered him. Nobody was performing a character.
- Southern Culture on the Skids. Same state, same decade, affectionate kitsch instead of grotesque. The gentler version of the same instinct.
- The Bloody Jug Band, Coffin Up Blood (2012) and Ghoultown, Tales from the Dead West (2001). If the horror-country lane is what you came for, these are the two album-level picks from that scene.

Watching

- Squidbillies itself, seasons 1 through 12. Free with ads on adultswim.com.
- Aqua Teen Hunger Force. Same Williams Street DNA, same deadpan absurdism.
- Metalocalypse. The closest analogue for a show where the music is genuinely good rather than a joke about music.

Watching and reading about him

There is no feature documentary, which is a real gap. The closest thing to a career retrospective is the pair of Wildwood Guitars sit-downs with Baker and Reverend's Ken Haas, "On Stuart's Story" and "On the Evolution of His Signature Guitar," notable because the character and the

craftsman are both in the room. Premier Guitar's Rig Rundown is the gear document. Adult Swim's behind-the-scenes featurette on recording the Squidbillies theme is the best short crossover artifact. Archived episodes of the original public-access show circulate on YouTube. In print, the American Federation of Musicians' International Musician profile is the most substantive piece written about him as a musician, and Charleston City Paper's 2019 feature is the best on the fact-versus-fiction question.

A Note on Sourcing

Three research passes fed this guide: one on the career and the record, one on production and craft, one on listening and recommendations. A few things could not be nailed down and are flagged where they appear. Reddit was unreachable, so no direct fan-forum consensus is represented here; the fan-consensus claims rest on Last.fm and Spotify play data, Episode Ninja fan voting, and editorial sources instead. RateYourMusic, AllMusic, Discogs, and TV Tropes all blocked automated access, so the discography crosswalk could not be verified against a single authority, which is why the Live and Undead year and label are given with conflicts intact. The Facebook and Instagram material about his health and the Veg McArtful revival is self-reported and not independently confirmed.

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